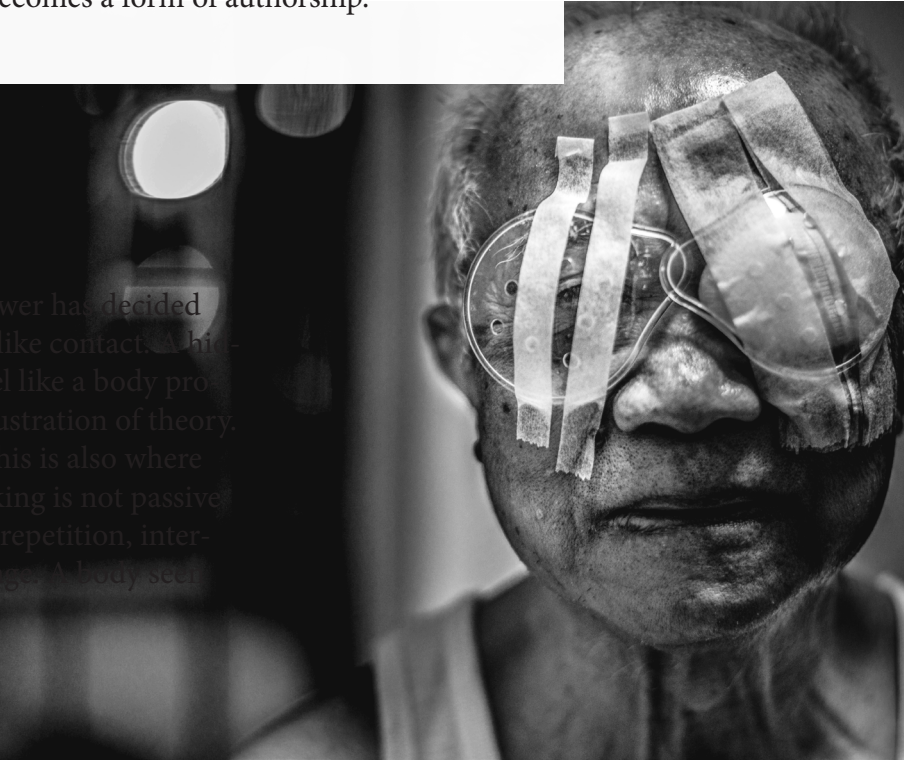




Gesture becomes a form of authorship.

A face can answer before language.

A face can answer before language. before the viewer has decided what kind of image this is. A direct stare can feel like contact. A hidden eye can feel like refusal. A turned face can feel like a body protecting its own interior life. The body is not an illustration of theory. It is the condition that makes theory necessary. This is also where the neural-learning backdrop enters quietly. Looking is not passive reception. The eye learns by comparing pressure, repetition, interruption, and contrast. A body seen once is an image. A body seen



The portrait asks to be met as a person, not a specimen.

The viewer meets a body, not a diagram.

The veil edits attention. The veil is an editing system, not a disappearance. The third movement begins where the body and the rule meet a surface that can

interrupt both. Lace, shadow, fabric, blur, flowers, hair, hands, and darkness all become interfaces. They do not simply hide the figure. They decide how slowly the figure can

arrive. The veiling route is held through iconography, Vera Icona, lace, secrecy, and the larger problem of mediated access. The key point is not that the

